

Comprehension-First eConsent

Redesigning informed consent for D4L Collect's move into clinical research.

UX Case Study

Product Designer application

Data4Life

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THE PROBLEM

Consent must satisfy regulators and people — today it satisfies neither.

CONTEXT

D4L Collect is moving from observational digital studies into clinical-research rigor — eCRF, ePRO, patient registry. eConsent is the participant's first interaction and the first trust-and-compliance priority named for this role.

PROBLEM

Consent must be complete enough for regulators (ICH-GCP, EU CTR, GDPR Art. 9) yet understandable for real people. Today the long document wins and comprehension loses.

Early withdrawal & re-consent

Ethics / audit risk

Hidden coordinator burden from verbal re-explanation

How might we raise genuine comprehension across diverse participants without sacrificing completeness or adding site workload?

Research approach, expected findings, and defining principles.

How I'd research it

- Participants (primary), coordinators, PIs / regulatory & QA
- Regulatory + health-literacy desk scan
- Baseline comprehension measure — adapted QuIC on current flow
- 8–12 discovery interviews across age, literacy & language incl. AT users
- Moderated observation of live consent sessions

What I'd expect to learn

- Consent reads as "terms & conditions" — skim and accept
- "Data-fate" questions dominate trust: what data, who sees it, how long, can I withdraw
- Comprehension is unequal across age, literacy & language
- Coordinators are the hidden comprehension patch
- Dense legal blocks aren't assistive-tech navigable

How that defines the problem

POV

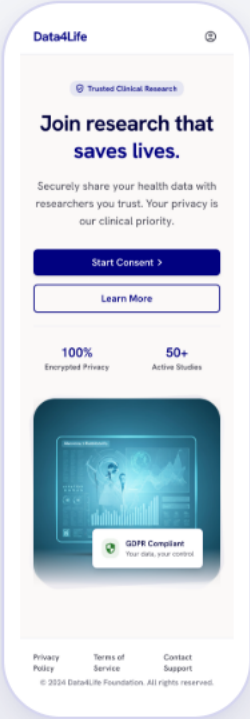
People are asked to agree before they're equipped to understand.

Principles

- Comprehension over completeness-as-default
- Progressive disclosure
- No dark patterns
- Accessibility-native
- Audit by design

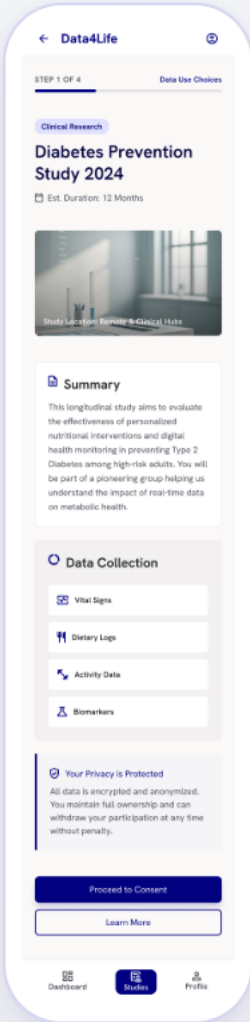
[↑ QuIC](#)[↓ Drop-off](#)[↓ Coordinator-assist](#)[WCAG 2.1 AA](#)

Layered Living Consent — plain-language understanding on to served regulatory text.



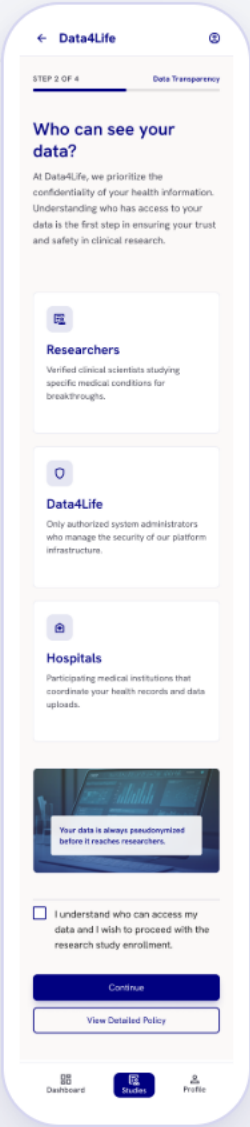
Step 0 · Entry

Calm onboarding sets the study context before any legal text appears.



Step 1 · Understand

Plain-language study overview with layered detail on demand.

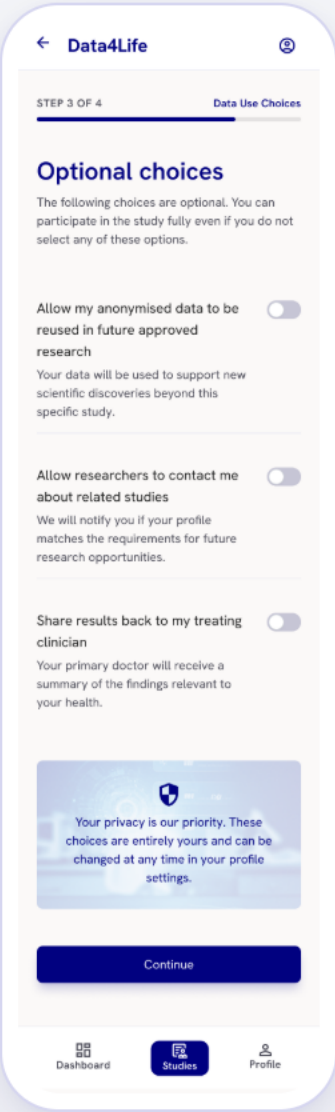


Step 2 · Read & understand

"Who can see your data" + a teach-back checkpoint. Calm amber clarification, never a red error.

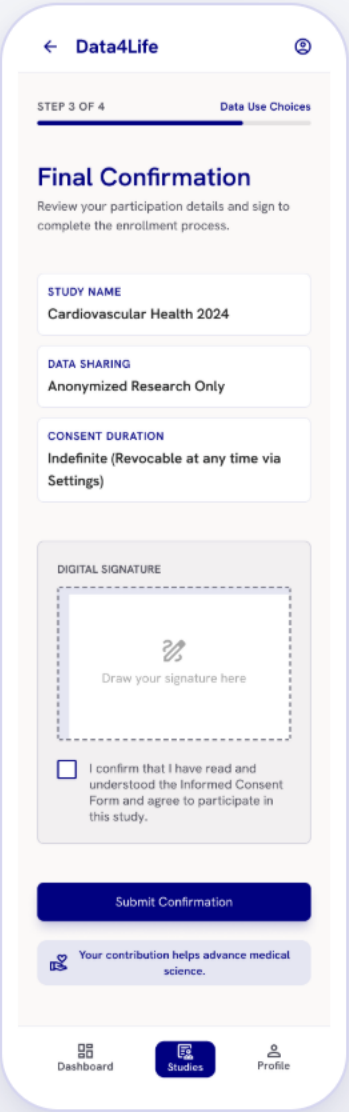
4-step flow — Understand → Read & understand → Optional choices → Confirm & sign + living "My agreements" record

Two decisions that make GDPR-valid consent visible and withdrawal a standing right.



Step 3 · Optional choices

All toggles default OFF with equal visual weight.
Participation never depends on opting in —
GDPR-valid, no nudging.

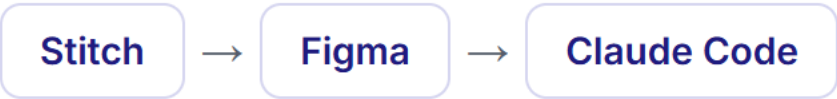


Step 4 · Confirm & sign

Plain-language recap of exactly what's agreed,
timestamped and versioned, exports to audit trail
with zero extra coordinator effort. Withdrawal
stays visible as an ongoing right.

Research-led practice, coded for real accessibility validation.

Process



- **Stitch** — divergent UI directions from a fixed, Data4Life-branded design-system prompt
- **Figma** — accessible component system: focus order, AA contrast, DE/EN
- **Claude Code** — coded prototype for real screen-reader, keyboard & timing validation Figma can't give

Testing

- RITE usability rounds
- QuIC comprehension re-test vs baseline
- Accessibility audit with assistive tech
- Live-study pilot



Why this role, why now

eConsent comprehension sits at the intersection of regulatory integrity and participant experience — exactly the space this role names. The design challenge isn't choosing between compliance and clarity; it's proving they're the same goal.

Regulation-as-design and WCAG 2.1 AA aren't constraints to route around here — they're the success criteria.

Signals of fit



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